```
some_klass.acts_like?(:string)
```

Rails has classes that act like `Date` or `Time` and follow this contract.

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/object/acts_like.rb`.

2.8 to_param

All objects in Rails respond to the method `to_param`, which is meant to return something that represents them as values in a query string, or as URL fragments.

By default `to_param` just calls `to_s`:

```
7.to_param # => "7"
```

The return value of `to_param` should **not** be escaped:

```
"Tom & Jerry".to_param # => "Tom & Jerry"
```

Several classes in Rails overwrite this method.

For example `nil`, `true`, and `false` return themselves. `Array#to_param` calls `to_param` on the elements and joins the result with "/":

```
[0, true, String].to_param # => "0/true/String"
```

Notably, the Rails routing system calls `to_param` on models to get a value for the `:id` placeholder. `ActiveRecord::Base#to_param` returns the `id` of a model, but you can redefine that method in your models. For example, given

```
class User
  def to_param
    "#{id}-#{name.parameterize}"
  end
end
```

we get:

```
user_path(@user) # => "/users/357-john-smith"
```

Controllers need to be aware of any redefinition of `to_param` because when a request like that comes in "357-john-smith" is the value of `params[:id]`.

Defined in `active_support/core_ext/object/to_param.rb`.

2.9 to_query

Except for hashes, given an unescaped `key` this method constructs the part of a query string that would map such key to what `to_param` returns. For example, given

```
class User
  def to_param
    "#{id}-#{name.parameterize}"
  end
end
```

we get:

```
current_user.to_query('user') # => "user=357-john-smith"
```

This method escapes whatever is needed, both for the key and the value:

```
account.to_query('company[name]')
# => "company%5Bname%5D=Johnson+%26+Johnson"
```

so its output is ready to be used in a query string.

Arrays return the result of applying `to_query` to each element with `_key_[]` as key, and join the result with "&":

```
[3.4, -45.6].to_query('sample')
# => "sample%5B%5D=3.4&sample%5B%5D=-45.6"
```